MCP

Title:

Brooke Marigold, PI

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Brooke Marigold, PI
A Humorous Piece
By Kevin J. Burgun

Suggested Doubling:

Performer 1:
Brooke Marigold
Teacher / Mrs. Gladstone
Patrol Officer Stacy
Teddy
Boss

Performer 2:
Trixie
Bobby
Detective Sparrow
Bus Driver
Mother

BROOKE: (As a noir detective voiceover) It was nap time. Thursday. The sun had been out earlier, but the clouds had recently come in casting a pall over the hopscotch court. The wind picked up a little. The “caution tape” strung around the monkey bars making a sound like streamers. But I wasn’t fooled. I knew what it meant. A case. Every time. So, I waited to Mrs. Gladstone to start scrolling the Gram. The rest of the kindergarteners were quiet. Too quiet. I took out my juice pouch, that’s right, a pouch, I never went in for the boxes. Boxes were for immature kids. I was a pouch girl. Precocious. Mrs, Gladstone said that once. The tone was’t flattering. I didn’t care. The word was. I’m Brooke Margold. I solve crimes.

MRS. GLADSTONE: Brooke, keep it down.

BROOKE: I didn’t have to wait too long. Two sips. And then she walked in. The dame.

TRIXIE: Brooke?

BROOKE: That’s what it says on my backpack, my lunchbox, my pencils, and my socks.

TRIXIE: I can’t find Teddy.

BROOKE: Boyfriend? Love triangle was my first thought. Trixie wasn’t the type to settle down. She colored outside the lines. I’d seen it. And she once turned a horse for an art project into a unicorn.

FLASHBACK

TRIXIE: Unicorn!

TEACHER: Trixie! Those are mythical creatures! The new state guidelines specifically forbid mythical creatures until May.

TRIXIE: Mommy always says: It’s May somewhere.

BACK TO PRESENT

BROOKE: She wasn’t constrained by society’s rules.

TRIXIE: Who are you talking to?

BROOKE: The kid was sharp. Maybe there was more to this than I had first thought.

TRIXIE: Can you help?

BROOKE: I charge by the hour.

TRIXIE: My mother just got back from Costco.

BROOKE: Juice pouches?

TRIXIE: And graham crackers shaped like dinosaurs.

BROOKE: Darn it, I only knew “darn it” so far. I once almost got a 3rd grader to teach me some swear words. But I’m pretty sure “flabbergasted” wasn’t going to cut it, dinosaur grahams, the kid knew my weak spot.

TRIXIE: Cinnamon AND Chocolate flavored.

BROOKE: Flabbergasted. I’m in. Tell me about Teddy.

TRIXIE: Well…

MRS. GLADSTONE: Okay girls, are you done with your nap early?

TRIXIE: I’ll nap when I’m dead.

BROOKE: Our teacher. Mrs. Gladstone. The one who took down Bobby.

FLASHBACK

BOBBY: You’ll never prove I put the gum under those desks in those kids hair, you hear me? You’ll never prove it.

MRS. GLADSTONE: I know you did it Bobby Drakenson. I know you did it.

BOBBY: If I did it, where are the wrappers then? Where are the wrappers?!

BACK TO PRESENT

BROOKE: She found the wrappers. Bobby went to the corner. And no one has questioned her since. Until today. Until Trixie. And I. And me. I? Me?

TRIXIE: And us!

MRS. GLADSTONE: Are you ready for show and tell?

TRIXIE: (Bursts out crying)

MRS. GLADSTONE: Oh dear, what’s wrong?

TRIXIE: (*still crying - like this is serious crying*)

BROOKE: The kid was nuts.

TRIXIE: TEDDY IS GOOOOOOOOONE. (*The longer you draw it out the better. Don't underestimate the deep breath at the end, then continuation.)*

BROOKE: You were going to show and tell your boyfriend?

TRIXIE: No, that wasn't my show and tell. But my teddy bear, Teddy, is gone.

BROOKE: That makes more sense than boyfriend.

BOBBY: Uh, Mrs. Gladstone, want me to run that errand now?

MRS. GLADSTONE: Do I have to micromanage you?

BOBBY: On it.

BROOKE: Flabbergasted Bobby Drake.

TRIXIE: Teddy was my best friend. I loved staring into his eye.

MRS. GLADSTONE: Oh, Trixie, dear, I am so sorry, where did you see him last?

TRIXIE: I had him this morning.

BROOKE: Where was the last place you saw him?

TRIXIE: On the bus, for sure. He was getting a little motion sick, so I had to pat his back.

BROOKE: The bus driver was a substitute today.

TRIXIE: He smelled like dill pickles and crushed dreams.

MRS. GLADSTONE: Maybe you left him on the bus, Trixie.

TRIXIE: But whyyyyyyyyyyyyyy?

BROOKE: Mrs. Gladstone, may I please go to the office?

MRS. GLADSTONE: Brooke Marigold, you aren't going to sneak out of school again to go on some crazy detective adventure, are you?

BROOKE: No, ma'am.

TRIXIE: You aren't?

BROOKE: (Aside) Of course I am, Trixie. I'm taking your case. I just have to dissemble a bit to Mrs. Gladstone.

TRIXIE: What does dissemble mean?

BROOKE: I don't know. But my mom uses it all the time after my dad comes home from working late. I think it's like a reason why you do something.

TRIXIE: Ohhhhhh.

BROOKE: Hang tight, kiddo. I'll have it solved by afternoon pick-up.

TRIXIE: Can I come with you?

BROOKE: I'm about to sneak out of school and track down a dangerous teddy bear napper. Of course you can come along. Every good detective needs a sidekick to watch her back.

TRIXIE: Yay! I'll dissemble to Mrs. Gladstone as well. I'll tell her I need to go poop.

BROOKE: That's good, and it also will explain why you don't come back right away.

TRIXIE: I'll tell her I'm consumated.

TRANSITION

DETECTIVE SPARROW: This better be good, dragging me out of bed.

PATROL OFFICER STACY: It's mid-morning, detective.

DETECTIVE SPARROW: Look, I'm a grizzled, cynical, weary detective 14 months from retiring. That's just what we say. It's in the manual.

PATROL OFFICER STACY: Sorry, I didn't read the manual. I'm an eager, fresh-face patrol officer who also thinks they know it all, so can't be bothered with manuals.

DETECTIVE SPARROW: Look at us, true originals. What do we have?

PATROL OFFICER STACY: Abandoned bus. Cameras inside disconnected. Inside the bus, it's not pretty, detective.

DETECTIVE SPARROW: Damnit. Kids? What evil is this?

PATROL OFFICER STACY: No, not kids. But there was…

DETECTIVE SPARROW: Out with it.

PATROL OFFICER STACY: Stuffing. Okay, there was stuffing.

TRIXIE: Stuffing?!

DETECTIVE SPARROW: Damnit, who the hell are you two?

BROOKE: One moment. (writes in notebook.)

DETECTIVE SPARROW: What are you writing?

BROOKE: How do you spell “hell”? Never mind, I’ll ask ChatGPT. Brooke Marigold, private investigator.

DETECTIVE SPARROW: Patrol Officer Stacy, I thought I told you to put up crime scene tape.

PATROL OFFICER STACY: I did! Detective I swear.

BROOKE: We walked right under it.

TRIXIE: I didn’t even need to duck.

BROOKE: It looks like our cases have rammed into each other. It’s okay, I’ll take lead.

DETECTIVE SPARROW: Kid, you have 5 seconds to get out of here, or ….

BROOKE: Detective…Sparrow, was it? I made a promise to Trixie here to find Teddy, her teddy bear, I don’t break my promises.

DETECTIVE SPARROW: You are going to break this one.

BROOKE: So, you don’t need me?

DETECTIVE SPARROW: I do not.

BROOKE: So, you know what happened here?

DETECTIVE SPARROW: We’ll figure it out.

BROOKE: Patrol Officer Stacy.

PATROL OFFICER STACY: Yes?

BROOKE: How much stuffing? .

TRIXIE: Teddy!!!!!!

PATROL OFFICER: More than I wanted to see.

BROOKE: But enough to think that Teddy is still viably a teddy a bear?

DETECTIVE SPARROW: What are you suggesting?

BROOKE: Are we looking for a teddy bear, or a pile of fabric?

DETECTIVE SPARROW: Kid!

BROOKE: Answer the question, Patrol Officer! Just stuffing? Did you see an eye?

(Long pause.)

PATROL OFFICER STACY: I'd say there's hope.

BROOKE: Detective, did you know that bus driver of that bus was a substitute?

DETECTIVE SPARROW: You don't say?

BROOKE: And I'm sure you already spotted the teddy bear paw prints in the oil slick over there. Indicating a teddy bear was dragged.

TRIXIE: Teddy!!!!!

BROOKE: Against its will, more than likely.

DETECTIVE SPARROW: Ok kid. You're in, but you mess up even once, and you are in a cell.

BROOKE: Deal. Now, let's get a look at this stuffing.

TRIXIE: Teddy!!!!!

TRANSITION

BOSS: Where is the diamond?

BUS DRIVER: Boss, it wasn't in the teddy bear. I looked.

BOSS: Our info said that the kid, Trixie Van Der El Van Hatterhornson, was bringing the King's Diamond to show and tell today.

BUS DRIVER: Right.

BOSS: And that the diamond was in or on the teddy bear.

BUS DRIVER: Right.

BOSS: Our inside rat told us that this Trixie was all upset that the teddy bear was taken.

BUS DRIVER: Right.

BOSS: Ipso facto…..

BUS DRIVER: Gesundheit.

BOSS: No, you idiot, ipso facto we have the diamond.

BUS DRIVER: I looked all through the bear. No diamond.

BOSS: You missed it.

BUS DRIVER: I brought the bear, here it is. Look.

TEDDY: *(look all disheveled, be still and quiet*)

BUS DRIVER: No matter what I did, it wouldn't talk. Would you bear?

TEDDY:

BUS DRIVER: Where's the diamond?

TEDDY:

BUS DRIVER: I'm not afraid to pluck out that radiant, sparkling, precious eye. You'll never see with proper depth again.

TEDDY:

BUS DRIVER: See, boss? Won't give it up.

BOSS: I've seen this before. Oh yes I have.

BUS DRIVER: What do we do?

BOSS: Bring me the girl. Trixie. Let's see how tough Teddy is then.

TEDDY: (*Eyes should widen in shock.*)

TRANSITION

DETECTIVE SPARROW: The paw prints suddenly stop.

BROOKE: Got into another vehicle.

DETECTIVE SPARROW: So, the bear is gone. Time to write it up. Stacy, that's on you.

BROOKE: Not so fast. Look.

DETECTIVE SPARROW: Tire tracks? So what?

BROOKE: Those aren't just any tire tracks, detective.

DETECTIVE SPARROW: You recognize the tire tracks?

BROOKE: I do. But. I never thought I'd see them again. Ever.

FLASHBACK

MOTHER: Now Brooke dear, you have too many stuffed animals, you need to give one away to the toy drive.

BROOKE: But I don't want to, Mother!

MOTHER: Brooke, you have to help others. What about this teddy bear here? You have another one exactly like it.

BROOKE: The twins?? You can't break up the twins!

MOTHER: It's settled, Brooke, in time, you'll see this is for the best.

BACK TO PRESENT

BROOKE: And that's the twenty-third most painful memory of my life.

TRIXIE: But Brooke, that means.

BROOKE: Yeah, Trixie. Yeah.

TRIXIE: We're related?

BROOKE: By teddy bear.

DETECTIVE SPARROW: But what does this have to do with the tire tracks?

BROOKE: Detective? Really?

TRIXIE: Try and keep up, detective.

TRANSITION

DETECTIVE SPARROW: The old warehouse district.

BROOKE: The old warehouse district.

TRIXIE: The old warehouse district.

PATROL OFFICER STACY: The old warehouse district.

DETECTIVE SPARROW: Patrol Officer? What are you doing here? I thought we left you back at the bus?

PATROL OFFICER: I follow my own rules.

TRIXIE: What's in the bag?

PATROL OFFICER: Teddy's stuffing. I put it in a cotton bag. 800 thread count. Keeping it on cotton in case we are in time to restuff.

DETECTIVE SPARROW: First we have to find the warehouse.

BROOKE: There's only one warehouse where you can't hear a teddy bear scream.

TRIXIE: What?

TRANSITION

BOSS: You're sure they are here?

BOBBY: Yup, I've been following them. That Brooke Marigold is a pretty fantastic detective.

BOSS: Arch nemeses usually are.

BUS DRIVER: Hear that, Teddy? Soon you'll be in a world of emotional pain and torture.

TEDDY:

BOBBY: So, about my payment. The gum?

BROOKE: Bobby Flabbergasted Drakenson.

DETECTIVE SPARROW: Everyone freeze. The gig is up.

BOSS: Detective.

DETECTIVE SPARROW: Do I know you?

BROOKE: She was talking to me. Weren't you? Miss?

BOBBY: I'm out of here, keep the gum!

BOSS / MRS. GLADSTONE: (Slow Claps) Well done, detective Marigold. Well done. (*Mimes taking off mask.*)

TRIXIE: (Gasp!) Mrs. Gladstone!

BOSS/ MRS. GLADSTONE: Trixie Van Der El Van Hatterhornson. How's the poop?

TRIXIE: I'm very very consumated.

BOSS/ MRS. GLADSTONE: Apparently.

DETECTIVE SPARROW: Your kindergarten teacher? But why?

BOSS/ MRS. GLADSTONE: But why? Does a public servant such as yourself really need to ask that?

TRIXIE: Where's Teddy?

BROOKE: The money. It's always about the money.

TRIXIE: Teddy is priceless!

BOSS/ MRS. GLADSTONE: For two long years, I dedicated my life to molding young minds. I endured sticky fingers, endless 'why's, and the symphony of a thousand off-key recorders. Do you know what it's like to be paid in peanuts while trying to teach children not to eat them?

TRIXIE: Mrs. Gladstone, I'm allergic to peanuts though.

BOSS/ MRS. GLADSTONE: I taught them to count, but had to skip my own lunch to balance my budget. I preached about the importance of sharing, while I couldn't even afford to share in a decent retirement plan. And let's not forget the mountain of paperwork! They told me it was about 'accountability.' Accountability?

DETECTIVE SPARROW: Mrs. Gladstone, you are under arrest for the destruction of a teddy bear and attempted robbery.

BOSS/ MRS. GLADSTONE: And then, the pièce de résistance—standardized testing! I became a drill sergeant of the alphabet, turning innocent playtime into a regimented nightmare. No longer could we turn horses into unicorns, we had to just (pause) color (pause) horses. So, I'm out. And this was my way out.

DETECTIVE SPARROW: Look at it this way, you are still out.

BROOKE: As soon as I saw those treads. Worn out. Almost bald. Only one profession can't afford new tires. Teachers. And only one teacher knew where Teddy would be today. You. Book her, detective. I need a juice pouch.

TRIXIE: But where is Teddy?

BOSS/ MRS. GLADSTONE: Where, indeed?

BUS DRIVER: He's just in the other room there. Remember?

BOSS/ MRS. GLADSTONE: That was my last bargaining chip!

DETECTIVE SPARROW: Substitute bus driver, you are under arrest for the mutilation of a teddy bear.

TRANSITION

TRIXIE: Teddy!

TEDDY:

TRIXIE: I'm sorry about all of this. But the the nice patrol officer has your stuffing. You'll be all better in no time!

TEDDY:

TRANSITION

DETECTIVE SPARROW: It's tough for me to say this, but good job, kid.

BROOKE: You didn't do half bad yourself.

(This next "scene" can be cut if one cannot figure out the choreography of it. If it's done, then you would keep the same "One thing bothers me" of the subsequent "scene".)

DETECTIVE SPARROW: There's one thing that still bothers me, though.

BROOKE: What's that?

DETECTIVE SPARROW: I'm a grizzled, cynical, weary detective 14 months from retiring.

BROOKE: And?

DETECTIVE SPARROW: Nothing happened to me. I didn't get shot. Or anything.

BROOKE: You're right. (Pause) Oh no.

BOBBY: Take that! (Bobby throws a piece of gum at the detective.)

BROOKE: Noooooooo!!!!! (Brooke jumps in front of the gum, taking the full force of it.)

DETECTIVE SPARROW: Kid!!!!!! Kid, kid, Are you okay? You took a piece of gum for me.

BROOKE: (Coughs) Watermelon twist.

DETECTIVE SPARROW: I owe you one.

BROOKE: To the next adventure.

(End the optional scene.)

DETECTIVE SPARROW: Just one thing bothers me though.

BROOKE: What's that?

DETECTIVE SPARROW: Where's the diamond?

PATROL OFFICER STACY: Teddy took the restuffing well. He’s back.

TRIXIE: I think Teddy can explain, detective.

TEDDY: You see, detective, our love for each other is the true diamond. Sacrificing for each other. Never giving up. Pushing each other to be the best we can be. That, truly, is priceless.

DETECTIVE SPARROW: So, there was no diamond?

TEDDY: Oh? The King’s Diamond? It’s my left eye.

BUS DRIVER: The eye!

END